PROJECT LONG COLT

Art Direction Reference Board

Multi-planet hard sci-fi war in the tradition of Nylund's Halo novels, Niven's Ringworld and Orson Scott Card. Feel: early-2000s military as in Halo 2 - fully sci-fi tech that is chunky, practical and field-maintained, never sleek. Marines are professional and dry-humored under a long war's weight. High-fidelity rendering, late-90s/early-2000s design sensibility: bold silhouettes, utilitarian industrial architecture, practical in-world lighting. Each planet has its own climate and palette; rain only on one level.

1. Armor / Soldiers
2. Weapons
3. Vehicles
4. Bases / Architecture
5. Megastructures
6. Planet / Environments
7. UI / HUD
8. Lighting / Palette

Copyrighted game art (Bungie-era Halo only) is internal reference only - do not ship.
Sources: Halopedia (halopedia.org) and Wikimedia Commons. Full list in sources.md.

Armor / Soldiers



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Take Halo 2-era Marine bulk: layered plates over fabric, webbing, pouches, scuffs and field repairs, read-at-distance helmet silhouettes. Ground it in IBA/PASGT proportions and how 2003-04 Marines actually wore kit. Avoid sleek one-piece suits, glossy panels and glowing trim.

[1] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_Marine_Concept_2.png
[2] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3_Marine_Concept_2.jpg
[3] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:1st_Battalion,_5th_Marine_Regiment_in_Fallujah,_Iraq_(7_April_2004).jpg
[4] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:U.S._soldier_in_1999_wearing_IBA_vest_with_PASGT_helmet.jpg

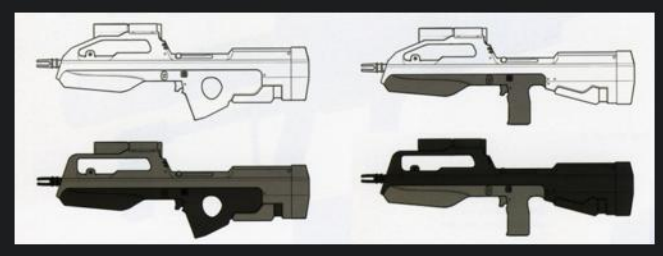
Weapons



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Blocky receivers, exposed fasteners, big readable mags and ammo counters; every gun should look like it can be cleaned by a tired Marine in the mud. Use M16A2/M249 wear patterns (worn finish, tape, slings) as texture reference. Avoid smooth sci-fi blasters, RGB accents and floating parts.

[1] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:M249_FN_MINIMI_DM-SD-05-05342.jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:A_US_Marine_Corps_(USMC)_Marine,_1ST_Battalion_(BN),_8th_Marine_Regiment_(1-8),_readies_his_5.56_mm_M16A2_rifle_during_
[3] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_BattleRifles_Concept.png
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HCE_AssaultRifle_2000_Crop.png
[5] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_M6GMagnum_Concept.jpg

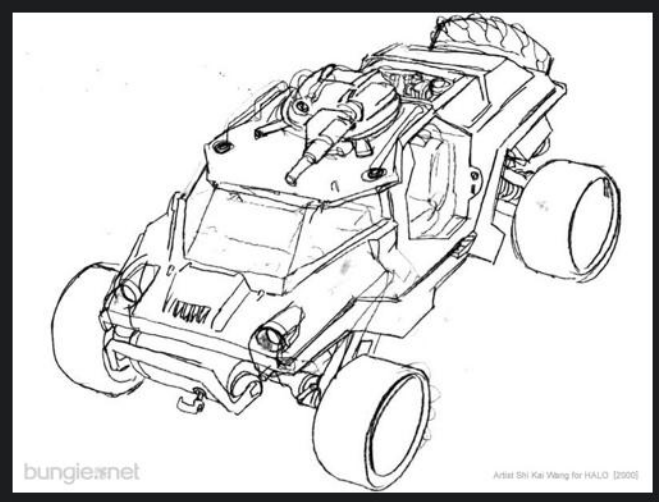
Vehicles



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Warthog/Pelican logic: exposed suspension, roll cages, tow points, stencils, mismatched replacement panels. Humvee/Abrams dust and fading drive material wear. Avoid aerodynamic swoops and spotless paint.

[1] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Iraqi_Sandstorm_(cropped).jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:US_Armor_in_Iraq_-b.jpg
[3] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HCE_EarlyWarthog_Concept_1.jpg
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_M831Warthog_Concept.jpg
[5] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_PelicanAirfield_Concept.jpg

Bases / Architecture



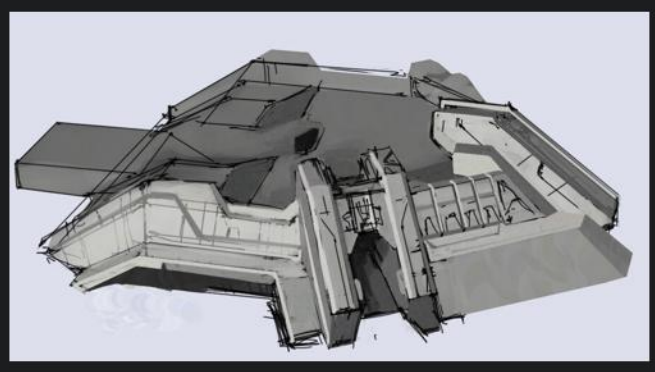
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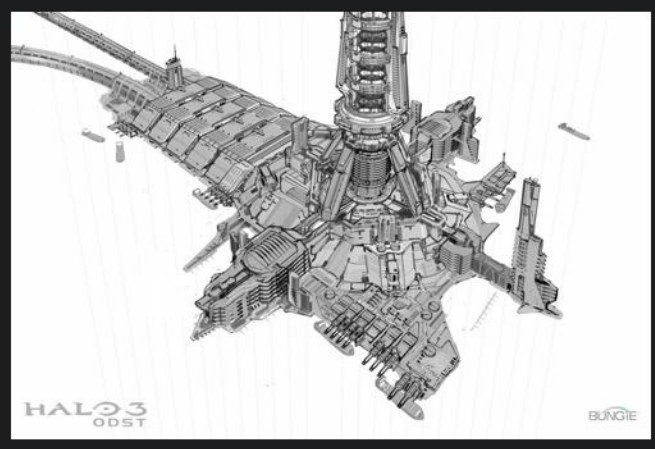
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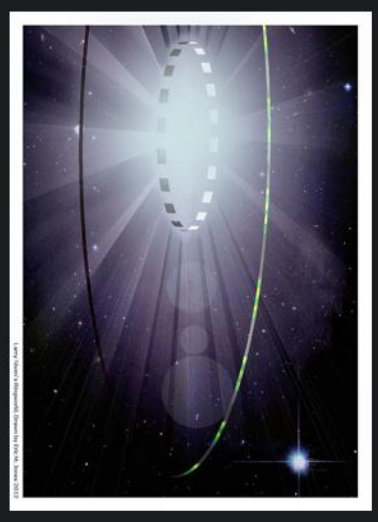


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Utilitarian industrial: prefab modules, concrete, HESCO-style barriers, cable runs, signage and floodlights over sculpted forms. FOB photos set scale and clutter. Avoid clean white sci-fi corridors and decorative greebling with no function.

[1] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_CairoBridge_Geo.jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Forward_Operating_Base_Broomhead_Iraq_in_2004_and_2004.jpg
[3] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:M3A3_Bradley,_Forward_Operating_Base_Wilson_in_Iraq,_Nov._16,_2004._Charlie_Troop,_1st_Battalion,_4th_Cavalry_Regiment,_1
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3_Valhalla_Base_Concept.jpg
[5] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3ODST_TetherBase_Concept_1.jpg

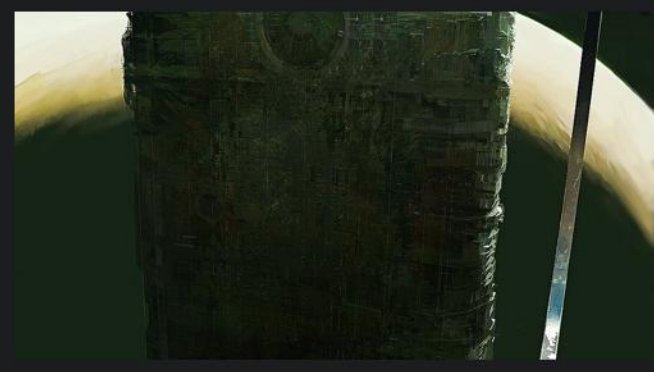
Megastructures



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Ringworld/Halo scale: horizon that curves upward, structures visible from every level as a constant presence. Keep forms bold and geometric, readable as a single silhouette. Avoid busy ornament; restraint sells scale.

[1] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ringworld_.jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Stanford_Torus_interior.jpg
[3] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HCE_Ringworld_Concept.jpg
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3_Installation08_Reveal_Concept.jpg

Planet / Environments



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One climate and palette per planet: arid ochre, frozen blue-grey, jungle green, plus one industrial rain level only. Real landscapes anchor the materials; Halo concepts show how to frame alien elements into them. Avoid mixing palettes inside a level and using rain anywhere else.

[1] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_WinterContingency_Landscape_Concept_2.jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Atacama_Desert_Landscape_(iced_moment_870-CC).jpg
[3] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Gargoyle_Ridge_in_the_McMurdo_Dry_Valleys_in_Antarctica_(30877661786).jpg
[4] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:JigsawCanopy.jpg
[5] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3_Ark_Desert_Concept.jpg

UI / HUD



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Helmet-visor HUD in the Halo lineage: minimal, corner-anchored, monochrome with one accent, motion tracker and ammo count as the core. Military HUD and Land Warrior refs give diegetic grounding. Avoid holographic clutter, gradients and glossy panels.

[1] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:An_artist%27s_concept_of_the_F-16_multimission_cockpit_head_up_display,_showing_a_pilot%27s_view_of_the_low_altitude_navi
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Land_Warrior_Iraq_071307.jpg
[3] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HCE-MjolnirMarkVHUD-screen1.png
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_-_SniperHUD.png
[5] https://www.halopedia.org/File:Halo_Reach_-_HUD.jpg

Lighting / Palette



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Arid ochre (proposed)



Frozen blue-grey (proposed)



Jungle green (proposed)



Rain-level industrial night (proposed)



Practical in-world sources only: sodium lamps, floodlights, work lights, NVG green, muzzle flash; light should come from objects you can see. Desaturated base palettes with one accent per planet. Swatches below are proposed, not sourced.

[1] https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3ODST_MombasaOutskirts_Concept.jpg
[2] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:U.S._Airmen_Enable_Marines_at_Al_Taqaddum_Air_Base,_Iraq_150701-M-VZ998-618.jpg
[3] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:A_U.S._Air_Force_HH-60G_Pave_Hawk_helicopter_assigned_to_the_83rd_Expeditionary_Rescue_Squadron_takes_off_at_Bagram_Ai
[4] https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_Nightfall_NightVision.jpg
[5] https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:DFC_2487_Quiet_urban_street_at_night_dimly_lit_by_streetlights_with_parked_cars_along_one_side_and_a_small_building_glowing